

Executive one-pager

Sequencing a back-office automation budget

automation-roi-explorer · Brandt Logistik & Handel GmbH (worked example)

€383,300 / yr

net saving and 13,460 hours freed across the five seeded processes, worked top-down.

Situation

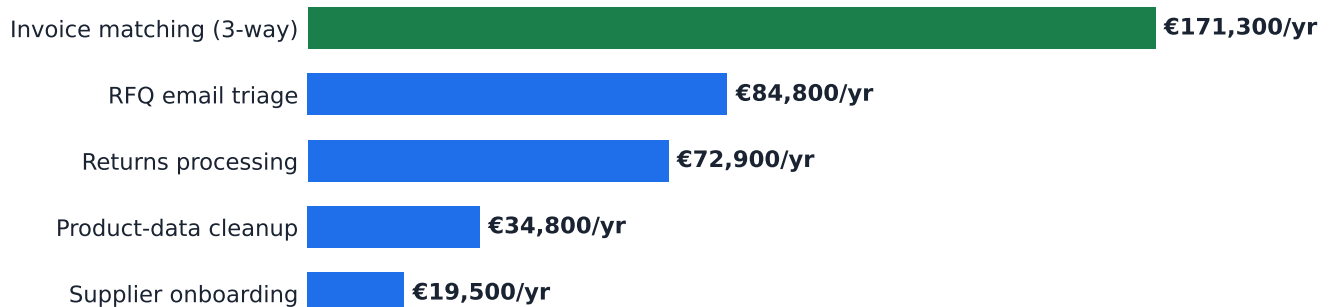
The COO has budget to automate roughly one back-office process at a time and a wish-list of five, each championed by its own team lead. The question isn't whether to automate — it's which one first, and whether it actually pays back.

The problem, quantified

The five candidate processes together consume ~22,400 hours/year of manual effort — roughly 13 full-time equivalents, ~€680,000/yr fully loaded. With a one-build-at-a-time budget, ranking them wrong is expensive.

Solution — rank every candidate by the value of automating it

One compute() function (mirrored in the dashboard) turns each process's volume, task times, wage, coverage, and costs into net €/yr, payback, 3y ROI, and NPV. Net annual saving per process:



Impact / ROI (from the model)

- **Build first:** Invoice matching (3-way) — €171,300/yr net, 2.8-month payback, 769% 3y ROI
- **Highest NPV:** €401,457 over 3 years (discounted at 8%)
- **Full portfolio:** **€383,300/yr net, 13,460 hours freed, €852,801 NPV**
- **Sequencing pays:** value-ranked, not first-come; low-volume supplier onboarding lands last

Recommendation

Fund Invoice matching (3-way) now — it clears its build cost in under three months and returns 769% over three years. Then work the backlog top-down; replace each estimate with real numbers as builds ship and let the ranking re-settle.

All euro/hour/ROI figures are computed by the real model and reproducible with ``python -m roi_model``. The five seeded processes are synthetic and adjustable. See docs/BUSINESS_CASE.md.